

Laura Contreras Portela

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EDUCATION

Aix-Marseille School of Economics

PhD in Economics

Marseille, France
(Oct 2022 – November 2026)

- Research fields: Development, International Trade, Labour, and Spatial Economics.
- Job Market Paper: “Place-Based Industrial Policy, Skill Scarcity and Labor Reallocation”
- Second chapter: “Public Care Provision and Domestic Violence: Evidence from Bogotá” (with Natalia Labrador).
- Third chapter: “The Impact of Export Opportunities on AI Innovation: Evidence from Indian Firms” (with Despoina Balouktsi and Priyam Verma).
- Work in progress: “Carbon Taxes, Technology Adoption, and Labor-Market Resilience in Latin America” with Dominik Biesalski; “Violence Across Generations: Evidence from Europe” with Natalia Labrador; “University–Industry Collaboration and AI Innovation: Evidence from India”.

UNU-WIDER

Visiting Research Fellow

Helsinki, Finland
(Aug 2025 – Dec 2025)

University College London

Visiting PhD Student hosted by Prof. Gabriel Ulyssea, Department of Economics & Institute for Fiscal Studies (TaxDev)

London, United Kingdom
(Mar 2025 – Jul 2025)

Aix-Marseille School of Economics

M.Sc. in Economics (with honors)

Marseille, France
(Sep 2020 – Jun 2022)

Universidad Externado de Colombia

B.A. in Economics

Bogotá, Colombia
(Jan 2017 – Dec 2021)

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

KEDGE Business School

Adjunct Lecturer

Marseille, France
(Sep 2026 – Present)

- Graduate: International Finance.

Aix-Marseille University

ATER (Teaching and Research Fellow)

Marseille, France
(Oct 2025 – Present)

- Undergraduate: Industrial Organization (2025–2026).
- Undergraduate: Statistical Inference (2025–2026).

International Labour Organization

Consultant (Remote)

Geneva, Switzerland
(May 2025 – Aug 2025)

Aix-Marseille School of Economics

Research Assistant

Marseille, France
(Jun 2021 – Aug 2021)

Universidad Externado de Colombia

Teaching Assistant

Bogotá, Colombia
(Jan 2019 – Jul 2020)

OTHER

Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (fluent).

Programming: Stata, Python, R, ArcGis, Matlab, L^AT_EX, Microsoft Office, Cloud Services.

Seminar/Conference presentations: 2026: SPANDE*, European Development Economics Group (EDEG) Conference, EAYE Annual Meeting, CSAE Conference. 2025: LACEA Annual Meeting, UNU-WIDER Seminar, Journées du Développement (JDD) Job Market Workshop, Helsinki Economics Group Development Seminar, LSE Workshop for Early Career Women in Economic Geography and Spatial Economics, IFS–UCL–LSE/STICERD Development Seminar, HEC Lausanne PhD Seminar. 2024: Junior Workshop, ENS de Lyon, LAGV Conference, Konstanz Brown Bag Seminar, Urban Economics Association Summer School, QMUL Workshop, AMSE PhD Seminar; 2023: AMSE PhD Seminar.

Scholarships, fellowships, and honors: Visiting Research Fellowship, UNU-WIDER; AMSE PhD Fellowship; Excellence Scholarship, Aix-Marseille School of Economics (2021–2022); Merit Scholarship, Universidad Externado de Colombia (2017–2021).

Academic activities: Co-organizer, Female Afterwork, Aix-Marseille School of Economics (2023–2025); co-organizer, SMILE Reading Group, Aix-Marseille School of Economics (2022–2024).